

The Need For Speed

Q I use Windows Server 2003. My printer prints very slowly—at a speed much lower than advertised. What could be the problem?

Ritesh Patil

A Printers always print at speeds lower than what the manufacturers advertise. However, there are many factors that affect the speed of a printer. Go to **Start > Settings > Printers** and right-click the default printer. Choose **Properties > Advanced** tab, and select the option “Print directly to the printer” rather than “Spool print documents so program finishes printing faster”. You can also check the printer spool settings to see if that is the cause of your problem: go to **Start > Settings > Printers**, right-click on your printer, then choose **Properties > Details > Spool Settings**. Change the spool data format from RAW to EMF, or vice-versa. (The location of this option, too, depends on the type of printer.) The other

most obvious determinant of print speed is the printer settings. Choosing a lower print resolution, for instance, or printing in black and white rather than in colour, can increase the speeds.

You could also try opting for the printer’s “high-speed” or “fast” printing mode. Almost all printer drivers have such a mode, optimised for day-to-day printing needs. If you need more speed, consider setting the printer to print multiple smaller pages per single sheet of paper. Consult the printer user’s manual for detailed instructions about how to activate the fast printing mode and adjust the pages-per-sheet setting.

Another important factor in determining print speeds is the health of the system. A system with lots of system memory, a neatly-organised hard drive with at least 100 MB of free space, and a powerful processor will be much more efficient in feeding data to the printer than a system that is lacking in these key areas. Install enough memory on your computer to take care of your needs. Run Disk Defragmenter periodically.

Dusty, Dirty, Defunct

Q My LG USB drive was working fine for the past one year. Now, when I connect it to my computer, it does show up as a removable disk in Windows Explorer, but the computer hangs when I click on the icon. Another problem is, when I use the “Safely Remove Hardware” from the System Tray, the notification message “Your USB storage device can now be safely removed” message pops up, but after a few seconds, the “Safely Remove Hardware” icon disappears.

This only happens on my home PC—the drive works fine on my office computer.

Kaushik Dey

A This problem usually occurs if your USB port has become dirty due to accumulation of dust, or if it has become loose because of wear and tear caused by plugging and unplugging of the drive. Clean it using a paintbrush and try to see if the problem goes away. Try using a different free USB port, or adding a port if you don’t have one. As far as your second query is concerned, it is normal for the “Your USB storage device can now be safely removed” message to go away after a few seconds.

DirectZip?

Q I have an Intel Pentium 4, 2.66 GHz, 256 MB RAM, and a 64 MB graphics card. *Dungeon Siege 2 Demo* didn’t run on my PC—I got the message “D3D initialization Failed.” I thought it was because I didn’t have DirectX 9.0c, but when I try installing it, setup runs and completes in just one second. Why?

Sahil Sharma

A You haven’t mentioned your graphics card chipset, and your issue is linked to dated graphics card drivers. Please update to the latest drivers from your graphics chipset’s manufacturer’s Web site—www.nvidia.com or www.ati.com, as the case may be. Also, run

DXDIAG and see if DirectDraw and Direct3D acceleration is enabled. If it isn’t, enable it.

DirectX 9.0c setup completes very quickly because you already have that version installed.

Forget It!

Q Any information entered in a Microsoft Word 2003 Wizard (such as the Resume Wizard) gets stored in the Registry, so when you call up the Wizard again, you can view the old information. We have many users working at the same computer, and the nature of our work is such that we do not want such information to persist after a session is done. What can I do?

Rohit Bhatt

A The data is stored in `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\11.0\Word\Wizards`. You can clear all the Wizard information each time the computer starts. Open Notepad and type in these two lines:

```
REGEDIT4
[-HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\11.0\Word\Wizards]
```

Save this file with the name “wizfix.reg”. Include the quotes to ensure that Notepad doesn’t save the file as a TXT file rather than as a REG file.

Now click on **Start > All Programs**, and find the Startup menu in the list. Right-click on it and choose **Open All Users**. Windows Explorer will open, displaying the shortcuts that define the menu items under the Startup folder. Right-click in an empty area and choose **New > Shortcut**. Enter “REGEDIT -S C:\Path\wizfix.reg” in the “Type the location of the item” dialog box, and click **Next** (assuming you saved the file to `C:\Path`). Give the item a name of your choice, such as “Delete Wizard data” and click **Finish**. The registry entries will be removed every time you start up. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!